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From Jobs to Judgment: The AI Shift in Work, Skills and Leadership

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TASKS · JOBS · MANAGEMENT · SKILLS · SENSEMAKING

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The question behind every AI conversation

“Is my job safe?”

A more useful question is:

“What will my job become?”

Anxiety becomes agency when people can see the future contribution.

Technology was not the hardest part

> **What I learned through transformation is that technology is rarely the hardest part.**
>
> **The harder work is redesigning roles and helping people see their place in the change.**

FACTORY • PLANNING • CAPABILITY



The structural shift

AI is changing the unit of work

COPILOT

Suggests

→

AI AGENT

Executes

→

DIGITAL WORK

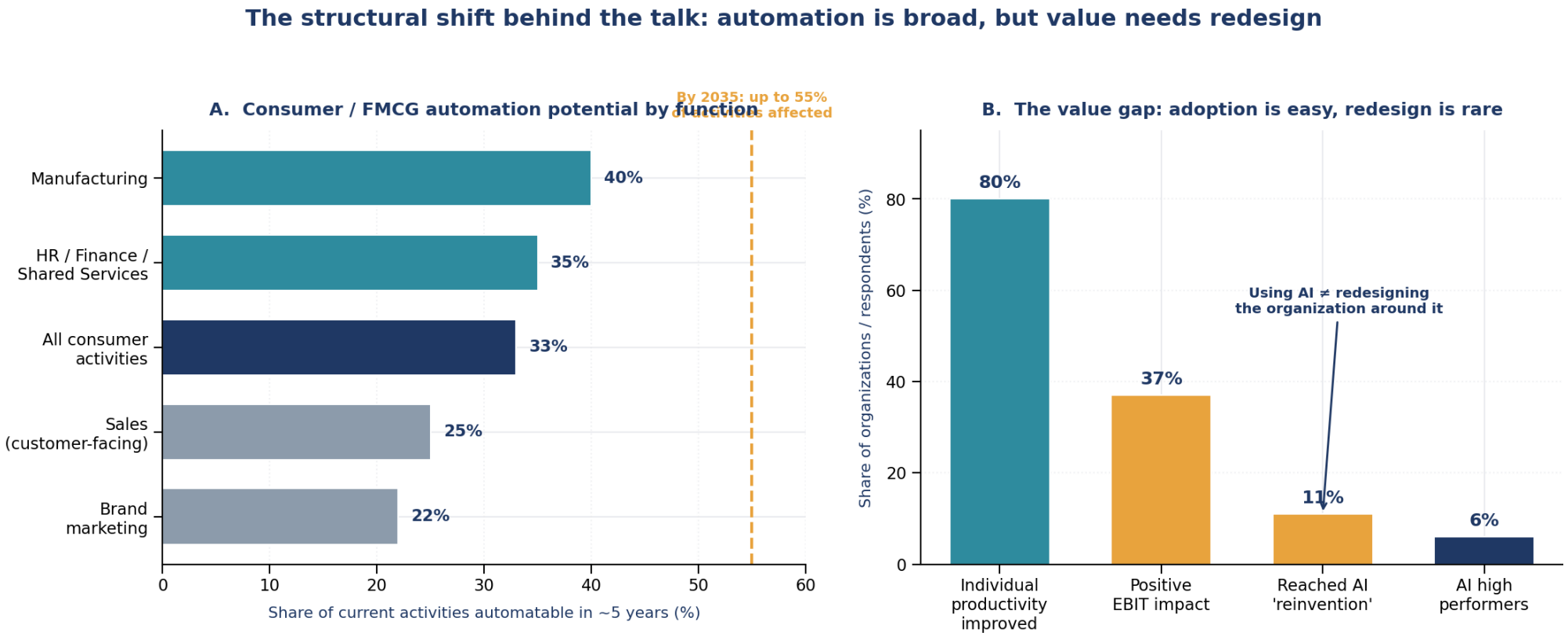
Coordinates steps

AI is moving from supporting a task to performing parts of a workflow.

The real opportunity is redesign—not automation alone

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Consumer data illustrates both the scale of change and the enterprise-value gap.



Sources: McKinsey, 'From blueprint to breakthrough' (consumer, Jun 2025) and McKinsey 2026 State of AI / 'AI is changing work' (Oct 2026).

Do not automate the current job description. Recompose the work around the outcome.

Two sectors. Different clocks. The same design challenge

AI meets physical risk in mining and consumer volatility in FMCG.

MINING

AI is embedded across exploration, production planning, equipment, processing and maintenance.

The work shift:

- from operating to supervising systems
- from reactive fixes to predictive intervention
- from isolated expertise to remote, cross-disciplinary decisions

Non-negotiable human value: safety, site context, engineering judgment, licence to operate

FMCG / CONSUMER GOODS

AI compresses the loop from consumer signal to shelf action across forecasting, manufacturing, supply chain, marketing and pricing.

The work shift:

- from reporting to rapid scenario choices
- from campaign execution to portfolio orchestration
- from functional hand-offs to end-to-end flow

Non-negotiable human value: consumer empathy, brand judgment, relationships, responsible choices

COMMON PATTERN

- less routine execution
- more exception handling
- more accountable judgment
- more cross-boundary work

Redesign the work

The real opportunity is not automation

AUTOMATE	AUGMENT	ELEVATE	STOP
Remove repetitive execution	Improve a human decision	Move time to higher value	Remove work with no value

Start with the workflow. Then redesign the role.

Orchestrating people and AI agents

Management becomes a capability



Many employees will manage digital work—even without direct reports.

HR must redesign the system—not bolt AI onto legacy practices

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Six mutually reinforcing moves turn isolated pilots into workforce transformation.

1 Map work

Outcomes → activities → decisions

2 Rebuild roles

Purpose, judgment, interfaces, agent ownership

3 Create pathways

Reskill, redeploy, apprentice, hire selectively

4 Reset performance

Evaluate outcomes, quality, learning and safe use

5 Equip leaders

Context, guardrails, trust and exception handling

6 Govern together

Business + HR + tech + risk + employee voice

Governance question: Who benefits, who carries the risk, and who has a voice?

Four connected shifts

HR must redesign the system around work

	FROM		TO
JOBS	Fixed descriptions	→	**Evolving accountabilities**
SKILLS	Credentials and courses	→	**Capabilities in real work**
CAREERS	Linear ladders	→	**Experiences and mobility**
LEADERSHIP	Supervision	→	**Orchestration and trust**

A no-regrets 90-day leadership agenda

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Start with one value stream, redesign it end to end, and scale what is learned.

0–30

CHOOSE

Select one meaningful workflow.
Map outcomes, activities, pain points and workforce impact.

Outcome clarity

31–60

REDESIGN

Allocate human / agent work.
Set decision rights, controls, role changes and learning pathways.

Accountable design

61–90

PROVE & LEARN

Pilot with employee voice.
Measure value, quality, trust and capability—not only time saved.

Evidence + adoption

Four measures to keep together

- business value
- quality & safety
- human agency
- skills gained

Scale the learning loop—not just the tool.

The future of work is not human or AI

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It is human judgment amplified by AI—designed responsibly.

REDESIGN	RESKILL	MAKE SENSE
work around outcomes	for judgment + orchestration	together, through action

When machines do more, our obligation is not merely to preserve work. It is to create work worthy of human capability.

Appendix: presentation summary

Presentation title: From Jobs to Judgment: The AI Shift in Work, Skills and Leadership

AI is not only automating tasks; it is changing the unit of work and the meaning of management. Drawing on more than two decades of HR leadership across FMCG and minerals, this presentation compares how AI is reshaping work in two very different operating environments. Mining is moving toward remote supervision, predictive intervention and safer, data-enabled decisions. FMCG is accelerating the loop from consumer signal to shelf through intelligent manufacturing, supply chains and commercial decisions. Across both sectors, employees increasingly orchestrate digital agents—setting goals, providing context, reviewing quality, handling exceptions and owning outcomes—even without direct reports. The strategic response is not generic upskilling or job reduction. Organizations must redesign workflows first, then rebuild roles, capabilities, career pathways and governance around human judgment and AI leverage. Sensemaking is the connective capability: helping leaders and employees interpret change, test new ways of working and turn uncertainty into responsible action. The goal is sustainable performance with human agency, trust and accountability.